

Shardul Mahindrakar

COMPS

Company: Nomura

Job Profile: ITD

Offer Type: Internship + Placement

Internship Stipend: 75k

CTC: 13.66 LPA

Location: Powai, Mumbai

Process Date: 31-07-2025

Interview Date : 01-08-2025

Placement Process:

Process involved:

1. Pre-placement talk
2. Aptitude test
3. Technical Interview 1
4. Technical Interview 2
5. HR Round

1. Preplacement Talk:

This was an online round. We were briefed about the company, its values and the roles they offered. There were 3 roles available for us in 3 different divisions, ITD, GM and CDO. It is recommended to have your webcam on and ask questions during the pre-placement talk.

2. Online Aptitude Test [181 Students appeared for the test]

This was an online aptitude test conducted on MeritTrac's Online Assessment Engine – PARIKSHA. The test consisted of 60 questions, with 20 questions each in the verbal, analytical,

and quantitative sections, with no negative marking. The time limit was 60 minutes so timing is the key here. The questions were of easy-medium difficulty.

Mostly, people use IndiaBix which is sufficient for practicing. I'd recommend solving the verbal and analytical questions first and then moving on to the quants as this section is time consuming. Some questions are purely in the test to waste your time. Try and identify these types of questions and keep them for the end.

I split the test into 10 minutes for verbal, 15-20 for logical and 30-35 minutes for the quantitative section.

Somebody had mailed the TPO about a cheating scandal in the OA test which prompted the TPO to inform the company about the same. Things like these tarnish the reputation of the college and further discouraged the company from hiring more students.

Due to the allegations, Nomura decided to take another written OA which consisted of 1 DSA question, 1 quant and 1 sql query within 20 minutes.

The dsa question was pretty easy where we basically had to return the largest sum of a contiguous part of an array. Since the entire array was given to be positive you can just sum up all numbers and return the total sum. In case the array contains negative numbers, Kadane's Algorithm can be used to solve this problem. I had written both approaches in my solution describing the cases.

Again the quant and query were pretty easy.

They used this test to eliminate 20 of the 27 students from interviews directly.

I had given my 1st Technical Interview before this test.

2. **Technical Interview - 1** [Remaining 7 students from the written OA were shortlisted for this]

This round started at around 10 am. I was asked to introduce myself. It happened before the written OA test.

Most of the early questions were based on my resume. I had mentioned a Spring Boot project and told him that Java is my primary programming language. So the next 80% of our discussion revolved around Spring Framework, Java and OOPS (I was very happy that he went towards this :)). He asked me about inheritance and polymorphism and gave me different scenarios. Also I was asked about binary search tree, quick sort algo and time complexity in general.

Then I was asked about the actual implementation of HashMap in Java and how the internal methods are implemented (also asked about hashing function, collisions and how they are handled). Next I was given a simple SQL query and asked some HR type questions.

Then we just talked casually about the entire placement process and asked me about my experience throughout the journey.

At this point we were having just a normal conversation about stuff and he asked if I had any questions for him to which I asked a couple and the interview ended.

This was a pretty chill experience for me since all the topics we discussed were my favs.

3. **Technical Interview - 2** [6 students were shortlisted for this round]

This round started at around 2:30 pm post lunch. There were 2 interviewers in each panel for this round. He asked me to give my introduction but nothing from my resume lol.

We started by discussing Spring Framework (yet again yess) and how it differs from MERN, its benefits and widespread use cases. We talked about JUnit testing and how unit testing works further delving into different types of testing methodologies.

They went through my resume and asked me detailed questions about the technical skills that I had mentioned in the resume. I was asked questions about MERN stack and databases used in my projects. We had a discussion about JWT and how it works. I was also asked about Hadoop and how it works (I had mentioned hadoop on my resume).

We also talked about how Spring Security works and how it is different from some other ways to secure web applications.

We discussed about Stripe (used in a project) payment gateway which is similar to razorpay and how it works. This was a relatively shorter round than the first one (1st was 75 minutes long) which lasted around 40 minutes.

4. **HR Round** [Total 3 candidates appeared for this round]

This was a pretty chill round as the HR and I were just having a fun conversation about my hobbies, Music, movies & series recommendations for him to which I recommended Chernobyl and The Green Book. Then he asked me how my usual day looks compared to the one we were having and I told him it had been unexpectedly smooth. I had mentioned a CFI course and he asked me about and I said it was purely out of curiosity about accounting. We talked about some things I had not mentioned on my resume and he wrapped things up from his side.

All 3 students (2 B.Tech + 1 MCA) were finally offered the role :)

Have 4-5 good projects covering important domains and use them appropriately for the JD you're applying for.

Interviewers often ask 2-3 niche questions to try and shake your confidence. In such times, try and steer the discussion to the nearest relatable topic/case you can think of instead of saying idk.

For vague questions or scenarios be upfront and ask them the details before assuming especially for puzzles and dsa questions.

I had done 90% of the Striver's A2Z DSA course and solved LeetCode Daily problems, maintained a streak of 300+ which covered most of the DSA areas. This was certainly a bit overkill but I enjoyed solving it. Solving even about 150 varied and good quality problems are enough.

For SQL, [leetcode-sql-50](#) will suffice (I personally did the first 30 only lol).

I didn't really practice for OAs specifically but Indiabix and Interviewbit are helpful.

I had made sure to do some web development in Spring Framework, since Java was my primary programming language.

Make sure every single thing mentioned on your resume is relevant and you have sufficient knowledge about the topics and projects mentioned.

Questions related to tech stack used, not used, why, how, are litmus tests for interviewers to test your technical knowledge and skills so be prepared for them.

The first few interviews might feel a bit overwhelming, but once you get the hang of it things get pretty easy. Keep a smile and just be yourself.

Some backstory up until this interview:

Sometimes interview rounds are quite tough. I was asked 5 DSA questions in the MSCI process, one of which was to implement heapify process and I couldn't recall and that was the only thing which I couldn't answer which got me out.

So sometimes even though you try your best, destiny wants you somewhere else :)

I got shortlisted for interview rounds for JPMC, UBS, MSCI, IDFC before Nomura.

IDFC was just a day before the Nomura OA and I had reached the final 4th round which was online which was taken by their IT Lead and welp I couldn't make it. I was pretty devastated with the result and my mental health took a hit since I was pretty confident on getting a positive result.

I gathered all the courage for the Nomura OA the very next day and my friends & family helped immensely getting through that.

The 15-20 days of placement season were no doubt some of the most tense days of my life.

The uncertainty, series of negative results plays tricks on your psyche.

There's a very good quote by Rick and Morty that sums up the process

'Everything will be fine in the end, Morty ; And if it isn't, it's not the end yet'
eventually everything will fall into place that's for sure.

It's ok to be anxious, there's no way not to be. Try and compose yourself and use the experience from negative results to iteratively work on weaknesses and better yourself.

Just know that some time in the future you will look back at this time and have a chuckle :)

Things might feel out of control or unlucky at times but have trust in your abilities and Keep giving your best cuz you only need luck to be on your side just once.

To everyone reading this, Best of Luck for your future escapades and know that you deserve the best!!

For any questions, you can find me here :

LinkedIn : [Shardul](#)